

E024

Product Launch

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A startup is launching invoicing software built for independent electricians and plumbers. Its draft launch message says “Invoicing for every business.” The founders met in college and the company has 14 employees. What should the product manager change?

- A. Highlight the founders’ college story.
- B. Keep the broad message to reach the largest audience.
- C. Position it for trade contractors, stressing the problem it solves for them better than generic tools.
- D. List every feature so each business finds something.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A project-management app is releasing a small improvement: users can now pick a dark-blue theme. Marketing proposes a press tour, a launch event, and a \$150,000 ad campaign. The app’s annual revenue is \$40 million. What launch level fits?

- A. A full tier-1 launch, because large companies launch everything big.
- B. A light launch: release notes and an in-app message.
- C. No communication at all.
- D. A launch event without the ads.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A company is launching a compliance tool for hospital IT security directors. The marketing team is excited about a viral video platform popular with teenagers, and the company’s office has a podcast studio. Which channel plan fits best?

- A. The viral video platform, because it has the largest audience.
- B. A new podcast, because the studio is available.
- C. Retail store displays.
- D. Healthcare IT conferences, industry associations, and targeted outreach to security directors.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A payment app's launch is set for Monday and the press has been briefed. On Friday, a readiness check agreed months ago finds that refunds fail for 10% of test cases. The launch party venue is non-refundable. What should the product manager recommend?

- A. Launch, since the venue cannot be refunded.
- B. Launch and fix refunds later, since 90% work.
- C. No-go (or a narrowed launch without refunds) until the criterion passes.
- D. Launch Monday since the press is expecting it.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A readiness review shows all critical criteria passed, but one minor item—a help article—is unfinished. What is the appropriate call?

- A. Go, with a plan to finish the article promptly.
- B. Go, and remove the help article from the plan.
- C. Redo the whole readiness review.
- D. No-go until every item is complete.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

The day after launch, a bug in a smart-thermostat app turns off heating for some customers in cold regions. The engineering manager is on vacation, and the social media team scheduled celebratory posts. What should happen first?

- A. Find who wrote the bug before acting.
- B. Contain the harm (roll back or disable the faulty feature), pause celebratory posts, and notify affected customers.
- C. Wait for the engineering manager to return.
- D. Stay quiet until a full fix is ready.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A launch defect is fully contained and customers have been informed. What should the team do next?

- A.** Find and fix the root cause, then hold a blameless review to prevent repeats.
- B.** Announce the defect never happened.
- C.** Cancel the product, since defects prove failure.
- D.** Close the incident; containment is enough.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A team plans this order for a new analytics add-on: press release Monday, customer webinar Tuesday, support-team training the following week. The add-on has a green logo and runs on three cloud platforms. What should change?

- A.** Train support only on the three cloud platforms.
- B.** Move the webinar before the press release.
- C.** Train sales and support before any external announcement.
- D.** Nothing; press should always come first.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A campaign that cost \$30,000 drew 40,000 visitors. 2% started a free trial, and 25% of trials became paying customers. The creative agency won a regional award. What was the customer acquisition cost?

- A.** \$6,000,000
- B.** \$0.75
- C.** \$37.50
- D.** \$150

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A team has \$24,000 to spend and a target CAC of \$120. If 25% of trials convert to paid, how many trials must the campaign produce?

- A.** 120
- B.** 200
- C.** 50
- D.** 800

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A new meal-kit service enters a crowded city market priced well below competitors to win customers fast, planning to raise prices once it has scale. Its kitchens are in a renovated factory. Which pricing strategy is this?

- A.** Penetration pricing.
- B.** Value-based pricing.
- C.** Cost-plus pricing.
- D.** Price skimming.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A company releases a new premium headset at a high price for enthusiasts, planning to lower the price over time to reach broader buyers. Which strategy is this?

- A.** Freemium.
- B.** Price skimming.
- C.** Penetration pricing.
- D.** Bundle pricing.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A startup is launching invoicing software built for independent electricians and plumbers. Its draft launch message says “Invoicing for every business.” ~~The founders met in college and the company has 14 employees.~~ What should the product manager change?

Target word: positioning fix **Decides:** The product is built for one segment; the message targets everyone.

A	Camouflage	Background does not decide positioning.
B	Inverted operation	Broad messaging weakens relevance to the real buyer.
C	Correct	Clear segment and differentiated value.
D	Adjacent category	A feature list is not positioning.

2. Answer B Concept 2

A project-management app is releasing a small improvement: users can now pick a dark-blue theme. Marketing proposes a press tour, a launch event, and a \$150,000 ad campaign. ~~The app’s annual revenue is \$40 million.~~ What launch level fits?

Target word: size the launch **Decides:** Small improvement, low impact.

A	Camouflage	Company revenue does not decide the tier.
B	Correct	Match effort to impact.
C	Absolute language	Even small changes deserve a note to users.
D	Dropped element	Still far larger than the change warrants.

3. Answer D Concept 3

A company is launching a compliance tool for hospital IT security directors. The marketing team is excited about a viral video platform popular with teenagers, ~~and the company’s office has a podcast studio.~~ Which channel plan fits best?

Target word: channel fit **Decides:** Buyers are hospital IT security leaders.

A	Inverted operation	Size without the buyer present.
B	Camouflage	Having a studio does not decide channel fit.
C	Adjacent category	Consumer channel for an enterprise product.
D	Correct	Reaches the actual buyer.

4. Answer C Concept 4

A payment app’s launch is set for Monday and the press has been briefed. On Friday, a readiness check agreed months ago finds that refunds fail for 10% of test cases. ~~The launch party venue is non-refundable.~~ What should the product manager recommend?

Target word: go/no-go decision **Decides:** A critical, pre-agreed criterion failed.

A	Camouflage	A sunk cost does not decide readiness.
B	Dropped element	Drops the pre-agreed criterion.
C	Correct	Failed critical criteria stop or reshape the launch.
D	Inverted operation	Lets the date override readiness.

5. Answer A Concept 4 • transfer

A readiness review shows all critical criteria passed, but one minor item—a help article—is unfinished. What is the appropriate call?

Target word: reverse: minor miss **Decides:** Only critical criteria block launch.

A	Correct	Minor items do not block when critical criteria pass.
B	Dropped element	Still needed; just not blocking.
C	Adjacent category	Nothing about the result requires starting over.
D	Absolute language	Treats every criterion as critical.

6. Answer B Concept 5

The day after launch, a bug in a smart-thermostat app turns off heating for some customers in cold regions. ~~The engineering manager is on vacation,~~ and the social media team scheduled celebratory posts. What should happen first?

Target word: first action in an urgent problem **Decides:** Customer harm is ongoing.

A	Adjacent category	Blame is not containment.
B	Correct	Contain, then communicate honestly, then fix root cause.
C	Camouflage	Availability of one person does not delay containment.
D	Inverted operation	Silence erodes trust and leaves customers at risk.

7. Answer A Concept 5 • transfer

A launch defect is fully contained and customers have been informed. What should the team do next?

Target word: reverse: step after containment **Decides:** Root cause and review come after containment.

A	Correct	Learning follows containment.
B	Inverted operation	Undercuts honest communication.
C	Absolute language	Defects happen; response matters.
D	Dropped element	The cause remains.

8. Answer C Concept 6

A team plans this order for a new analytics add-on: press release Monday, customer webinar Tuesday, support-team training the following week. ~~The add-on has a green logo and runs on three cloud platforms.~~ What should change?

Target word: communication sequence **Decides:** Support is briefed after customers.

A	Camouflage	Platforms do not decide timing.
B	Adjacent category	Still leaves support untrained.
C	Correct	Internal enablement comes first.
D	Absolute language	Leaves support unable to answer questions.

9. Answer D Concept 7

A campaign that cost \$30,000 drew 40,000 visitors. 2% started a free trial, and 25% of trials became paying customers. ~~The creative agency won a regional award.~~ What was the customer acquisition cost?

Target word: CAC **Decides:** $40,000 \times 2\% = 800$ trials $\times 25\% = 200$ customers.

A	Inverted operation	Multiplies spend by customers.
B	Wrong stem number	Divides by visitors.
C	Dropped element	Divides by trials, dropping the trial-to-paid step.
D	Correct	$\$30,000 \div 200 = \150 .

10. Answer D Concept 7 · transfer

A team has \$24,000 to spend and a target CAC of \$120. If 25% of trials convert to paid, how many trials must the campaign produce?

Target word: solve back up the funnel **Decides:** $\$24,000 \div \$120 = 200$ customers $\div 0.25$.

A	Wrong stem number	Reuses the CAC as a count.
B	Dropped element	That is customers; drops the conversion step.
C	Inverted operation	Multiplies by 25% instead of dividing.
D	Correct	$200 \text{ customers} \div 25\% = 800$ trials.

11. Answer A Concept 8

A new meal-kit service enters a crowded city market priced well below competitors to win customers fast, planning to raise prices once it has scale. ~~Its kitchens are in a renovated factory.~~ Which pricing strategy is this?

Target word: name the strategy **Decides:** Low entry price to gain share.

A	Correct	Starts low to win share quickly.
B	Adjacent category	Sets price by perceived value, not below-market entry.
C	Confusion set	Adds a markup to cost; the stem sets price relative to competitors.
D	Inverted operation	Skimming starts high.

12. Answer B Concept 8 · transfer

A company releases a new premium headset at a high price for enthusiasts, planning to lower the price over time to reach broader buyers. Which strategy is this?

Target word: reverse: high entry price **Decides:** High start, lowering later.

A	Confusion set	Free base tier with paid upgrades.
B	Correct	Captures early adopters first.
C	Inverted operation	Would start low.
D	Adjacent category	Prices a group of products together.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	6	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	9	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	2	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	6	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Positioning and target segment	A go-to-market plan names one primary target segment and positions the product by the problem it solves for them and how it differs from alternatives.	Targeting “everyone” or positioning by feature list.	A launch message that tries to reach all audiences.
2	Launch tiers	Size launch effort to impact: major new products get a full (tier 1) launch; small improvements get lighter launches.	Giving every release the same big launch.	A minor update with a large proposed budget, or vice versa.
3	Channel and marketing mix fit	Choose channels where the target buyer actually is and match price, promotion, and place to the product and segment.	Picking the channel the team likes or the biggest audience.	A specific buyer profile paired with a channel choice.
4	Go/no-go criteria	Launch readiness is judged against criteria agreed in advance (quality, support, legal, sales readiness); a failed critical criterion delays or narrows the launch.	Launching on the announced date regardless of a failed critical check.	A launch date and an unmet readiness item.
5	Handling an urgent launch problem	Contain customer harm first, communicate honestly and early to affected stakeholders, then fix root cause and review.	Staying silent until a full fix is ready, or assigning blame first.	A defect or incident found just before or after launch.
6	Internal enablement before external announcement	Sales, support, and partners must be trained and equipped before customers hear about the product.	Announcing publicly, then briefing support after tickets arrive.	A sequence of launch communications.
7	Funnel and CAC math	Customers = top-of-funnel × each conversion rate; CAC = marketing spend ÷ new paying customers.	Dividing spend by visitors or trials instead of paying customers.	Spend, visitors, and conversion percentages.
8	Pricing strategy	Penetration pricing starts low to win share quickly; skimming starts high for early adopters and lowers later; value-based pricing follows customer-perceived value.	Mixing up penetration and skimming.	A price level set relative to competitors and a goal.

Course scope (public description): Product Launch has the student role-playing as a Product Manager, overseeing the launch of a technical product. The student will develop a plan for the launch, simulate a solution to an urgent problem that threatens the success of the launch, and evaluate a marketing plan for a technical product. The course covers skills in strategic communications and planning, marketing planning and strategies, new product development, product knowledge, and problem-solving. There are no prerequisites, but the following courses are recommended to be completed prior to beginning Product Launch: Product Strategy and Product Design.